You Choose the Way

Civic Skill: Voice & Participation | EYLF: EYLF Outcome 4 (Learning) & Outcome 5 (Communicating) | Duration: 20–30 minutes | Age: 4–6 years

LEARNING INTENTION

Modelled on mosaic methodology, children will explore part of their own space using a self-chosen method — a camera tour, a drawn map, or a guided walk — to share their perspective on what could change.

SUCCESS CRITERIA

- I can choose a way to show my ideas about our space.
- I can point out a favourite place and explain why.
- I can suggest one change I would make.

MATERIALS

- Child-safe cameras or tablets
- Clipboards and paper for mapping
- Drawing materials
- A designated area of the room or yard currently being considered for change

ACTIVITY STEPS

1. INTRODUCE THE EXPLORATION (3 min): 'We're going to be explorers of our own space. You get to pick how you show us what you find.'

2. CHOOSE YOUR METHOD (2 min): Introduce three choice stations: camera tour, mapping, and drawing-and-labelling. Children choose the method that suits them.

3. EXPLORATION TIME (10 min): In small groups, children explore the designated area using their chosen method. Educator circulates, asking: 'What do you notice here? What would you change?'

4. RETURN AND SHARE (8 min): Groups share their findings with the whole circle — photos, maps, or drawings.

5. OUR SPACE BOARD (5 min): Compile findings into a shared display mapping favourite spots and suggested changes.

EXTENSIONS	ASSESSMENT
• Revisit the board after any changes are made — did children's suggestions have an impact? • Invite a facilities or maintenance person to view the suggestions and respond • Repeat with a different area of the setting later in the term	• Note the range of methods children chose and whether some children moved between methods • Observe the reasoning children give for their suggested changes • Document the 'Our Space' board as a strong Mosaic-style artefact combining multiple children's perspectives

EDUCATOR REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Which method elicited the richest information, and from which children?
- Did any child's suggestion surprise you or reveal something you hadn't noticed about the space?
- How could child-led space reviews like this become a regular part of your environment planning?

EYLF LINKS

This lesson directly supports EYLF Outcome 4 (Learning) & Outcome 5 (Communicating). Educators should record observations using anecdotal notes, photographs, or learning stories focused on children's language, body responses, and social interactions during the session.